Flatcar Container Linux: Growing the Cloud Native OS Ecosystem

Project Lightning Talk, KubeCon + CloudNativeCon North America 2026



Jan Bronicki

Flatcar Maintainer, Software Engineer at Microsoft

@John15321 jan-bronicki

Growing in the CNCF



- CNCF **incubating** project, with graduation on the roadmap
- Runs Kubernetes nodes on the major clouds and bare metal
- Alpha, Beta, Stable and LTS channels, each release tested across clouds before it ships
- Extensible by design: Docker, containerd, Podman and GPU drivers ship as **sysexts**

Supply chain integrity



- Signed **SPDX SBOM** published with every image
- Assessed at **SLSA Level 3**, per-package provenance in `/usr/share/SLSA/`
- Coming: **VEX files** with every release, so you know which CVEs matter
- Next: TPM chain of trust, scalable release signing

Roadmap, and where you can help



- **Now:** CNCF graduation, systemd-sysext and confext, TPM and Secure Boot
- **Next:** full-disk encryption, a more automated release pipeline
- **You:** good first issues, docs, testing new platforms, sysext images
- Find us: **Project Pavilion, kiosk P-8A**, Hall 5, Cosmic Canyon Zone
- Shifts: **Tue 3-7 PM, Wed 1:55-5 PM, Thu 12:25-2 PM** (MST)

Secure by design.
Open by default.
Come build it with us.

Join our Discord!

flatcar.org

github.com/flatcar

discord.gg/PMYjFUsJyq

Office hours · every 2nd Thu, 16:30 CEST **Dev sync** · every 4th Thu, 16:30 CEST